

# Pre-Listing Prep & Styling Checklist — South Australia

Getting your property market-ready without overspending on the wrong things.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal, financial or valuation advice.

## Section 1 — Before You Spend Anything

- ☐ [ ] **Start your Form 1 (Vendor's Statement) preparation early.** Since this document triggers your buyer's short 2-day cooling-off window once served, having it genuinely complete and accurate before your first open home reduces the risk of a buyer using an incomplete disclosure to reconsider.
- ☐ [ ] **Get a professional appraisal from 2-3 agents** before deciding your preparation budget.
- ☐ [ ] **Decide: renovate, style, or sell as-is?** Major renovations rarely return their cost dollar-for-dollar in a short pre-sale timeframe.

## Section 2 — High-Return, Low-Cost Improvements

- ☐ [ ] **Declutter aggressively** — consistently the highest-return, lowest-cost step.
- ☐ [ ] **Deep clean throughout**, including often-overlooked areas.
- ☐ [ ] **Fix small, visible defects** — leaking taps, cracked tiles, chipped paint.
- ☐ [ ] **Freshen paint in neutral tones** where walls are marked or dated.
- ☐ [ ] **Improve street appeal** — especially relevant given Adelaide's currently competitive, low-vacancy property market where first impressions genuinely drive inspection turnout.

## Section 3 — Styling Decisions

- ☐ [ ] **Consider professional staging for vacant properties.**
- ☐ [ ] **For occupied properties, focus on de-personalising** rather than full staging.
- ☐ [ ] **Get professional photography and floor plans regardless of styling budget** — not an area to cut costs on.
- ☐ [ ] **Ask your agent for their honest opinion on styling ROI** for your specific property.

## Section 4 — Compliance Items to Check Before Listing

- ☐ [ ] **Check smoke alarm compliance.**
- ☐ [ ] **If in a community titled scheme, gather your records** — recent meeting minutes, financials, and any known disputes or special levies.
- ☐ [ ] **Address any known structural or building issues honestly in your Form 1** — given SA's short buyer cooling-off window, an accurate disclosure upfront reduces the risk of the sale unwinding shortly after signing.

## Section 5 — Timing Your Campaign

- ☐ [ ] **Discuss timing with your agent relative to market conditions.**
- ☐ [ ] **Align your preparation timeline with your agent's proposed campaign start**, factoring in the time needed to get your Form 1 genuinely ready.
- ☐ [ ] **Plan your own moving logistics in parallel** — see the separate Pre-Settlement Checklist in this series.

## Quick Reference — Where to Spend, Where to Save

| HIGH-RETURN, LOW-COST              | OFTEN LOWER-RETURN RELATIVE TO COST           |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Decluttering                       | Full kitchen/bathroom renovations             |
| Deep cleaning                      | High-end fixture upgrades                     |
| Minor repairs                      | Structural changes shortly before sale        |
| Professional photography           | Extensive landscaping overhauls               |
| Fresh neutral paint (where needed) | Full furniture replacement for occupied homes |

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